

David Lawrence Pollard

pollardld@gmail.com
727-542-5158
pollardld.com

github.com/pollardld
linkedin.com/in/pollardld

Software engineer with over 10 years of experience building and sustaining open-source, data-intensive products across climate, conservation, Indigenous knowledge and public-interest technology. Lead engineering strategy, product delivery, applied AI research and cross-functional collaboration while remaining active in architecture and implementation. Experienced in translating scientific research, community knowledge and complex institutional requirements into durable systems that people can use and organizations can sustain.

Employment

Managing Software Engineer

[Ecotrust](#) | San Francisco, CA | January 2025 to current

- Lead technical strategy, delivery & long-term stewardship across a portfolio of environmental and public-interest software products spanning forestry, oceans, climate & data sovereignty.
- Manage and mentor a Senior Software Engineer through project direction, technical guidance, performance management and professional growth planning.
- Co-authored and scaled Landmapper, an open-source forest-stewardship platform used to map 5,443 tax lots covering more than 2 million acres across Oregon and Washington.
- Led multi-year engineering of an open-source Indigenous Traditional Knowledge database with Tribal partners, embedding data sovereignty into product architecture and governance; the work was cited in a 2026 CHI paper.
- Lead Ecotrust's applied AI work, including org policy development, tool evaluation and research into retrieval-augmented generation, computer vision & environmental decision-support systems.

Senior Software Engineer

[Ecotrust](#) | San Francisco, CA | January 2021 to January 2025

- Own critical infrastructure and deployment work, including containerization and AWS migration for a production ocean-data platform.
- Led engineering for OceanAdapt, a public decision-support tool translating 40 years of research on 650+ marine species into an accessible interactive experience; the underlying research contributed to the Fourth National Climate Assessment.
- Modernized production platforms across Django, Wagtail, React, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and Docker, improving maintainability while preserving continuity for long-running public programs.

Software Engineer

[Ecotrust](#) | San Francisco, CA | January 2018 to January 2021

- Turning forest hydrology models into a scenario workflow that forest and stream restoration practitioners can use to support decision making, for salmon recovery in north-central Washington.

As builder of the scenario workflow, I ensured it was both scientifically rigorous & practically useful.

- Designed full-stack and geospatial workflows that allowed practitioners to compare restoration scenarios without needing to operate the underlying scientific models directly.
- Developed and maintained public-facing environmental data products using Python, Django, JavaScript, SQL, geospatial data and cloud infrastructure.

Software Experience Developer

Ecotrust | Portland, OR | August 2016 to January 2018

- Lead on the statewide directory connecting school meal programs with local producers, ranchers, fishers, and tribal foods. The search and filter interface allows users to easily find and connect with local sources.
- Contributed across frontend engineering, UX, and product..

Full Stack Developer

Alta Planning & Design | San Francisco, CA | March 2014 to August 2016

- Designed interactive transportation planning tools for cities & states used by 600,000+ residents.
- Introduced DevOps practices, cutting software deployment times by 30% & reducing system downtime.

Front End Developer

Bisk Education | St. Petersburg, FL | January 2012 to March 2014

- Created a front-end framework for an online education platform, improving accessibility and user experience for students across several universities.

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Django, React, Node.js, HTML, CSS, Sass

Data and geospatial systems: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, SQL, NoSQL, GDAL, OpenLayers, remote sensing data pipelines, environmental data infrastructure

AI and machine learning: Applied AI, AI engineering, retrieval-augmented generation, TensorFlow, computer vision, model integration and evaluation

Infrastructure and engineering: Docker, AWS, Google Cloud, APIs, automated testing, CI/CD, DevOps, production operations and platform modernization

Leadership and product: Engineering management, technical strategy, product stewardship, mentoring, research leadership, cross-functional collaboration, grant and contract delivery, human-centered design

Education

University of Washington, Machine Learning, MOOC, August 2022 to May 2023

St. Petersburg College, Computer Science, August 2010 to May 2012

University of North Florida, Sports Management, B.S., August 2006 to May 2011